

MarEng Grammar

THE PAST TENSE

Study these sentences:

Last year I **went** for a holiday to Spain.

I **stayed** in a small hotel by the sea.

I **swam** in the sea and **sunbathed** on the beach.

In the evening I **sat** in an outdoor restaurant and **watched** the people.

I **ate** Spanish food and **drank** Spanish wine.

I **enjoyed** my holiday very much.

THE PAST TENSE - USE

The Past Tense is used about **an action that happened at a definite time in the past**. The action is not connected to the moment of speaking - it is finished.

Sir Francis Drake **grew up** in Plymouth. He **lived** from 1540 to 1596. In 1577 he **set out** on his famous voyage and **sailed** round the world. He **returned** to England in 1580 and **became** one of the most famous Englishmen of his age.

THE PAST TENSE REGULAR VERBS - PRONUNCIATION

The Past Tense of regular verbs has the ending **-ed**. The ending is pronounced in three ways:

1) after voiceless consonants p, k, f, s, sh, ch pronounced (t)

- wash washed (t)
- finish finished (t)
- watch watched (t)
- help helped (t)
- work worked (t)

2) after voiced consonants b, g, m, n, ŋ, l, r, v, z, (d)

- stab stabbed (d)
- enter entered (d)
- cry cried (d)
- move moved (d)
- manage managed (d)
- pull pulled (d)

3) after -t or -d (id)

- end ended (id)
- start started (id)

THE PAST TENSE IRREGULAR VERBS

Many verbs are irregular. They take no ending -ed in the Past Tense.

Three forms are usually given for the irregular verbs:

(See the List of Irregular Verbs)

The Infinitive

write

The Past

wrote

The Participle

written

The Second form is the Past Tense. Learn them by heart!

Examples: Sir Francis Drake **grew up** in Plymouth.

He **set out** on his voyage round the world in 1577.

THE PAST TENSE QUESTIONS

Study these sentences:

Where **did you go**? I **went** to Spain.

Where **did you stay**? I **stayed** in a small hotel.

Did you eat Spanish food? Yes, I **did**.

Did you speak Spanish? No, I **didn't**.

Did you meet any interesting people?

Yes, I **met** some very nice English people.

Did you see any interesting sights?

I **saw** an old church and a castle, but I **didn't see** much of the countryside.

Questions are formed with the auxiliary **did** + the basic form of the main verb.

Negations are formed with **did not (didn't)** + basic form of the main verb.